

Before you start

The platform is at aies-system.vercel.app. Sign in with your own account — the walkthrough moves between four people on purpose, because the gates are the point and a gate you can walk through yourself is not a gate.

First sign-in for an account that has not been used: you will be asked to change the password, and then to set up an authenticator app. Both are required and neither can be skipped. Keep the recovery codes you are shown — there is no administrator who can reset an authenticator for you, and that is deliberate.

How to read a step

Each step names who does it, where to go, what to do there, and what should happen. If what happens is not what the step says, stop and write down which step and what you saw. That is the finding — not a fault to work around.

A note on refusals

Several steps below will refuse to do what you ask. A quotation with no cost will not be submitted; a job with no client approval will not mobilise; a final statement will not be raised for work that is unfinished. Every refusal names what is missing and whose it is. Those are the controls the platform was built for — the walkthrough is as much about checking they hold as it is about the happy path.

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Part 1 — The enquiry arrives

Everything starts as an inquiry, whether it came by email, on the phone, or from somebody walking in. Nothing further in the platform can happen until one exists.

1. Log the inquiry

EM (Sales and Marketing) or DJ (Operations)

Where: Sidebar ' Sales ' Inquiries ' "Log inquiry"

What to do

- Choose the customer account, or create one if this is a new customer.
- Give it a subject in the customer's own words — "two 75kW motors rewind", not "motor job".
- Add the items or scope as far as they are known. Unknowns are fine at this stage.
- Set the required-by date if the customer gave one.

What should happen

- A number of the form AIESINQ-26xxxx.
- Status: new. A one-working-day clock starts on acknowledging it.

2. Acknowledge it

Whoever owns the inquiry

Where: Sales ' Inquiries ' open the inquiry ' "Acknowledge"

What to do

- Press Acknowledge once you have replied to the customer.

What should happen

- Status moves to acknowledged and the SLA clock stops.
- Left unacknowledged past one working day, it escalates — that is the platform chasing, not a fault.

3. Complete the requirements

EM or DJ

Where: The inquiry ' the requirements checklist on the record

What to do

- Work down the checklist for this kind of job and tick what has been received.
- Where a document is needed, upload it.

What should happen

- The checklist shows what is still missing.
- You cannot move the inquiry to quoting until the mandatory items are in — that is the gate, and it is deliberate.

This is where most of the back-and-forth with a customer lives. The checklist is the record that it happened.

4. Request a site inspection, if the job needs one

DJ

Where: The inquiry ' "Request inspection"

What to do

- Name the technician and the date.
- Say what needs looking at.

What should happen

- The technician is notified and it appears on the calendar.
- The SLA clock pauses while an inspection is outstanding.

5. Move it to quoting

EM

Where: The inquiry ' "Start quoting"

What to do

- Press it once the requirements are complete.

What should happen

- A draft quotation is raised automatically and linked to the inquiry.
- The inquiry is now quoting. Find the draft under Sales ' Quotations.

Part 2 — The quotation

A quotation is the company's price and its terms. Two gates stand between a draft and a customer: it must have a cost behind it, and the Vice President must approve it.

6. Build the quotation

EM

Where: Sales ' Quotations ' open the draft

What to do

- Add a line per item or scope of work.
- Enter the supplier cost against each line, and the margin you intend.
- Choose the payment terms — this decides the billing schedule later, so it matters.
- Set the validity date.

What should happen

- The total, the VAT and the margin update as you type.
- Local jobs are numbered AIESLQ26xxxx; indent jobs AIESIQ26xxxx.

7. Meet the cost gate

EM

Where: The quotation

What to do

- Make sure every line has a cost — not an estimate typed into the description.

What should happen

- With a line costed at zero the quotation refuses to be submitted, and says which line.
- This is what stops a job being sold at a price nobody checked.

8. Send it for approval

EM

Where: The quotation ' "Submit for approval"

What to do

- Press it.

What should happen

- It appears in KJ's queue at Sales ' Quotations for Approval.
- KJ is notified. After 24 hours with no decision it escalates to EA.

9. Approve or reject

KJ (Vice President)

Where: Sales ' Quotations for Approval

What to do

- Open it, check the margin and the terms.
- Approve, or reject with a reason.

What should happen

- Approved: the quotation can now be sent.
- Rejected: it goes back to EM with the reason attached, and the reason is kept.

10. Send it to the customer

EM

Where: The quotation ' "Send"

What to do

- Download the PDF and send it to the customer from your own email.
- Then press Send so the platform knows it has gone.

What should happen

- Status: sent, with the date.
- A follow-up reminder is scheduled seven days out.
- The validity date now counts down; it expires on its own if nothing comes back.

Part 3 — The customer's purchase order

The customer's PO is the moment the job becomes real. It is the single act that turns a quotation into a sales order and starts everything downstream.

11. Record the customer's PO

EM

Where: Sales ' Pipeline ' the "Received PO" column, or the quotation ' "Record PO"

What to do

- Enter the customer's own PO number and its date.
- Upload the PO document itself — this is the paper the job is done against.
- Confirm the amount matches the quotation. Where it does not, say so; the difference is recorded rather than hidden.

What should happen

- A sales order is raised: ALESSO-26xxxx.
- The quotation is marked won, and the inquiry closes with it.
- Tasks appear for sales, operations, procurement and finance — automatically.

Check My Work straight after this step. Four tasks should be waiting, and that is the platform replacing the meeting where those jobs used to be handed out.

12. Look at the sales order

DJ

Where: Orders ' Sales orders ' the new order

What to do

- Read the lines: which are supply-only, which need work on site.
- Check the billing schedule panel below the header.

What should happen

- A billing schedule generated from the payment terms on the quotation.
- A downpayment milestone, if the terms have one, sitting at ready to bill.

Part 4 — Money before the work starts

Where the terms call for a downpayment, the platform will not let the job mobilise until it is in. This is the first of the two places money is collected.

13. Raise the downpayment statement

Finance

Where: Finance ' Ready to bill

What to do

- Find the milestone for this order and press "Raise a statement".
- Check the amount and the due date.

What should happen

- A draft billing statement: AIESBS-26xxxx.
- Nothing has gone to the customer yet — a draft is not a demand.

14. Issue it

Finance

Where: Finance ' Statements ' the draft ' "Issue"

What to do

- Issue it, then send the statement to the customer.

What should happen

- Status: issued. It now appears in Receivables and starts ageing.

15. Record the payment when it arrives

Finance

Where: Finance ' Statements ' the statement ' "Record payment"

What to do

- Choose the method. For a cheque, enter the cheque number and its date.
- Enter the amount received. If the customer withheld tax, enter what actually arrived.

What should happen

- A payment: AIESPMT-26xxxx, and a service invoice: AIESSI-26xxxx.
- A cheque sits as pending until you clear it — the money is not counted before the bank has it.
- Where tax was withheld, the statement stays part-paid until the 2307 form arrives. That is intentional.

16. Print the service invoice

Finance

Where: The statement ' the service invoice ' "PDF"

What to do

- Open the PDF.

What should happen

- A reference copy, marked as such. AIES issues the official invoice on its registered external form; this is what you copy from.

Part 5 — Buying what the job needs

Runs in parallel with the work. Procurement is PD's.

17. Ask suppliers for prices

PD (Admin Manager)

Where: Orders ' Procurement ' "New RFQ"

What to do

- Pick the suppliers — several at once is normal.
- List what is needed.
- Send, then record each supplier's reply as it comes back.

What should happen

- AIESRFQ-26xxxx, and a comparison across the replies.
- Applying an offer copies its prices onto the order rather than making you retype them.

18. Raise the supplier PO

PD

Where: Orders ' Procurement ' "Raise supplier PO"

What to do

- Choose the supplier and confirm the lines and prices.

What should happen

- AIESPO-26xxxx, requiring approval before it is sent.
- Above the threshold it needs a second approval — the clause 8.4 control.

19. Receive the goods

PD

Where: Orders ' Procurement ' the PO ' "Record receipt"

What to do

- Enter what actually arrived, line by line. Short deliveries are recorded as short.
- Note any damage.

What should happen

- AIESGRN-26xxxx.
- A three-way check between the PO, the receipt and the supplier's invoice. Differences are shown with their numbers, not just flagged.

Part 6 — Doing the work

Every job runs through the same gates, and each one exists because skipping it has cost the company money before. A gate refuses with a reason; read the reason.

20. Generate the tickets

DJ

Where: Orders ' Sales orders ' the order ' "Generate tickets"

What to do

- Press it.

What should happen

- One ticket per piece of work: AIESTKT-26xxxx.
- A project record for the job as a whole, and a channel for it under Collaboration ' Channels.

21. Site inspection

DJ

Where: Operations ' Site inspections

What to do

- Record what was found, who attended, and photographs.
- If the scope has changed, say so here — it raises a revision task for sales.

What should happen

- AIESSI-26xxxx, with the photographs attached to the record rather than in somebody's phone.

22. Method statement, and the client's approval of it

DJ

Where: Operations ' Method statements

What to do

- Prepare the statement, or upload the client's own form where they insist on theirs.
- Submit it to the client, then record their approval when it comes.

What should happen

- AIESMTH-26xxxx.
- Work cannot mobilise until the client has approved. Always.

23. Materials

DJ, then PD

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' "Raise material request", then Operations ' Store

What to do

- Raise the request against the ticket.
- PD approves it and issues from the store, recording who took what.

What should happen

- AIESMR-26xxxx.
- What the store cannot supply becomes a purchase task for PD.
- Tools issued are on a custody list until they come back.

24. Cash advance

The crew lead, then Finance

Where: Finance ' Cash advances ' "Request", then Finance ' Cash to release

What to do

- Request the advance, saying what it is for and when it is needed.
- It is approved, then released. Record the release when the money actually goes.

What should happen

- AIESCA-26xxxx.
- A liquidation deadline is set the moment it is released, and it appears on the calendar.
- Somebody with an overdue liquidation cannot request another advance.

25. Mobilise

DJ

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' the mobilisation panel

What to do

- Check the readiness list and mobilise.

What should happen

- It refuses while anything is outstanding — downpayment, method statement, materials, crew — and names what.

26. Record progress each day

The crew

Where: Operations ' Delivery mode (on a phone), or the ticket

What to do

- Record what was done, hours worked, and photographs.
- Record standby time and why, if the crew was held up.

What should happen

- Hours reach the job's cost once approved at Operations ' Hours and expenses.
- Standby with a reason is what makes a claim against the client possible later.

27. The client's QA

DJ

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' the QA panel

What to do

- Record the client's verdict and upload their evidence.
- Where it failed, record each defect.

What should happen

- AIESQA-26xxxx.
- A failure raises rectification work and a re-inspection automatically.

28. Testing and commissioning

DJ

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' the T&C panel

What to do

- Record the results and any punch items.

What should happen

- AIESTC-26xxxx and a certificate.
- Accepted commissioning is what opens final billing.

29. Demobilise and liquidate

The crew lead

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' demobilisation, then Finance ' Cash advances

What to do

- Record the demobilisation and reconcile the tools.
- Liquidate the advance: receipts in, unspent cash returned.

What should happen

- Anything not returned is listed by name.
- Only approved liquidation lines count as job cost.

30. Service report and close-out

DJ

Where: Operations ' the ticket ' service report, then Operations ' Projects

What to do

- Write the service report and have the client sign it.
- Work down the close-out checklist on the project.

What should happen

- AIESSR-26xxxx.
- The project closes only when the checklist is clear, and it says what is blocking it.
- Closing raises the final invoice task for finance.

Part 7 — Delivery, where the job is supply-only

Supply lines take the delivery lane instead of the site gates above.

31. Issue the delivery receipt

PD

Where: Operations ' the delivery ticket ' "Request DR"

What to do

- Request the DR, and confirm the site contact before the vehicle leaves.

What should happen

- AIESDR-26xxxx.

32. Record what happened at the door

The driver

Where: Operations ' Delivery mode, on a phone

What to do

- Capture the recipient's signature, or record the attempt as failed and why.

What should happen

- A failed attempt raises a task to contact the customer and reschedule.
- A signed DR is what makes the delivery billable.

Part 8 — Final billing and the money in

The last stretch. Everything here is finance's, and the gate before it is the reason the rest of the platform exists.

33. Check the final billing gate

Finance

Where: Orders ' Sales orders ' the order ' the billing panel

What to do

- Read the gate.

What should happen

- It lists the seven conditions and names the owner of anything outstanding.
- It will not let a final statement be raised while work is unfinished — which is what stops AIES billing for a job it has not delivered.

34. Raise and issue the final statement

Finance

Where: Finance ' Ready to bill ' the milestone ' "Raise a statement", then Issue

What to do

- Check the amount against the order and the variations.
- Issue it and send it to the customer.

What should happen

- AIESBS-26xxxx, ageing from its due date.

35. Record the payment

Finance

Where: Finance ' Statements ' the statement ' "Record payment"

What to do

- Bank transfer: enter the reference and the amount.
- Cheque: enter the number and date, then clear it when the bank confirms.

What should happen

- AIESPMT-26xxxx and the service invoice.
- A bounced cheque reverses cleanly and the statement goes back to outstanding.

36. Record the 2307 when it arrives

Finance

Where: Finance ' Statements ' the statement ' "Record 2307"

What to do

- Enter the withheld amount and the form's date.

What should happen

- The statement closes to paid.
- Until the form is in hand the withheld amount keeps ageing, because AIES has neither the cash nor the credit.

37. Check the job actually made money

Finance

Where: Operations ' Projects ' the project ' the P&L panel

What to do

- Compare the quoted margin with the actual.

What should happen

- Contract value, cost, and margin — with caveats named: hours with no cost rate, advances not yet liquidated.
- Where an advance is still out, it shows what the margin becomes once it is liquidated.

38. Chase what is still owed

Finance

Where: Finance ' Receivables and Finance ' Collections

What to do

- Work the ageing list.
- Log each call or email against the customer.

What should happen

- Ageing buckets, and the credit exposure per customer.
- A logged conversation is what the next person picks up from.